

Career Compass x Naukri (InfoEdge)

Customer-Acquisition Strategy & Call Brief · Prepared for Vardaan Aggarwal, Koenig AI Academy · 17 Jun 2026

Career Compass

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India

1. The product, in one line

Career Compass is a free AI tool for job-seekers: **upload your CV + a target job → it analyses your skill gaps, recommends short AI/tech upskilling courses, and prepares you for the interview.** Free today; a paid tier (₹99–₹199 per course / per CV-match report) comes later. The goal of this exercise is the **right customers and real value delivered — not near-term revenue.**

2. Why Naukri's audience is the ideal fit

A Naukri job-seeker is *exactly* our customer: they already have a **CV** and an **active job target** — the two inputs Career Compass needs. We help them close their skill gap and walk into the interview prepared. Naukri has **70M+ registered job-seekers** and is India's #1 job portal, so relevant-audience density is unmatched.

3. What we learned about Naukri / InfoEdge

a) Naukri's ad products are built for recruiters, not for promoting an external site.

Their advertising (display/branding, NVite email-to-candidates, Insta-Hire SMS, app push) is designed for *employers reaching candidates about jobs*. There is **no off-the-shelf B2C product** for sending an external upskilling site to their users — so this is the **first thing to clarify on the call** (is it allowed, and via which surface?).

b) There is NO advertiser API / self-serve / automation — it is 100% sales-managed.

Naukri offers job-posting APIs for recruiters, but **nothing for programmatically creating/optimising ad campaigns**. Every campaign runs through an account manager → Naukri is a **manual, relationship-driven** channel, not auto-pilotable (unlike Meta/Google, \$5).

c) Coopetition flag — InfoEdge has its own upskilling product.

Naukri FastForward / Naukri Learning is InfoEdge's in-house reskilling offering. Worth being aware of — a *risk* (they may not promote a competitor) **or** an *opportunity* (content/affiliate partnership).

d) The best-fit InfoEdge surfaces may not be Naukri.com itself:

- **Shiksha.com** — InfoEdge's **course-discovery** portal. Natural home for an upskilling offer; intent-aligned.
- **hirist.tech / iimjobs.com** — premium **tech** & management audiences; high-intent, smaller.

e) Budget reality

₹1L is roughly an entry-level *managed* spend. No public rate card — pricing is negotiated. Expect a display + email/SMS bundle proposal.

4. The 6 questions to ask Naukri on the call

1. **Policy:** Can we promote an **external upskilling site** (Career Compass) to your job-seekers — via display, email (NVite), or SMS — or only job/employer advertising?
2. **Automation/integration:** Any **API, bulk-upload, or file export/import** to create & manage campaigns — or only via an account manager?
3. **Targeting:** Can we target by **role / skill / experience / location**? Can we upload/refine a **custom audience**?
4. **₹1L test:** For a ₹1,00,000 pilot, what product mix, and what **CPM / CPC / cost-per-lead**? Is there a rate card?
5. **Attribution:** What **click/conversion data** do you return, and can it feed our analytics (UTM/postbacks)?
6. **Shiksha / partnership:** For a course/upskilling offer, does **Shiksha.com** — or a **FastForward partnership** — fit better than Naukri.com display?

5. Where Naukri fits — Naukri vs Meta

	Naukri / InfoEdge	Meta (Facebook + Instagram)
Audience fit	Excellent — active job-seekers with CVs	Very good — interest/lookalike targeting
Intent	High (actively job-hunting)	Medium–high (interest-based)
Automation	None — fully manual/managed	Full — Marketing API; create→optimise→pause by software
Cost (India)	Negotiated, opaque; ₹1L = managed pilot	CPL ~₹200–400; ₹1L ≈ 200–400 CV-analysis conversions/mo
Best role	Relationship / managed pilot , premium intent	Always-on, auto-piloted volume engine

Read: Naukri is a high-intent *relationship* channel worth a managed pilot; **Meta is the channel that matches the "advertising on auto-drive" vision** — fully controllable by our AI org via the Marketing API. We pursue both; we *automate* Meta (and likely Google Search), and run Naukri as a managed experiment.

6. Recommended first move + the ₹1L framing

- **Success metric = "CV-analysis completed" conversions** (a real, engaged user), not revenue. Our site already tracks this (PostHog).
- **Naukri:** if external-site promotion is allowed, run a **₹50k–₹1L managed pilot** on their recommended surface (likely display + NVite email, or Shiksha), with **UTM tracking** to measure cost-per-CV-analysis.
- **Meta (in parallel, we control):** ₹1L test — Conversions objective on `analysis_completed`, 2–3 ad sets (broad India 20–40, IT pros/freshers, retargeting), Reels-first creative ("Find your AI/tech skill gaps in 2 minutes — free"). Expect ~200–400 conversions/mo.
- **Compare cost-per-CV-analysis** across both after 30 days → double down on the winner, automate it, add the next channel.

To actually run the test we'll need: Naukri — the call outcome (policy, targeting, pricing, attribution, Shiksha option). Meta — a Business Manager + ad account + Page + payment (OTP/GST) + the Pixel on

the site, then we automate the rest. Decision — whether to also switch on **Google Search** (highest intent, fully automatable).

7. CMO recommendation (AI marketing lead)

Bottom line: start Meta today (automatable + measurable), use the Naukri call to open a Shiksha partnership rather than buy Naukri.com display, and keep InfoEdge spend small and attribution-gated.

Channel ranking

- **Meta — do now, don't wait on the call.** The only channel we fully control and can measure in days; optimise on `analysis_completed` (~₹200–400 per CV-analysis). Our volume engine.
- **Shiksha.com — the InfoEdge surface to actually pilot.** Course-discovery intent = exactly our offer; cheaper and more aligned than Naukri.com display.
- **Naukri.com display/NVite — last.** Highest density but recruiter-centric, opaque, manual, FastForward cooptation risk. Small managed pilot ONLY if the call clears policy + attribution.
- *hrist/iimjobs* — *hold* for a later targeted test, not the ₹1L.

Position it as partnership, not competition

Don't pitch Career Compass as an "upskilling platform" (that triggers the competitor reflex vs FastForward). Pitch it as a **free, top-of-funnel CV→skill-gap diagnostic that sends qualified, course-ready learners downstream — including into their own Shiksha/FastForward courses.** That makes us an audience/affiliate *partner* feeding them intent, not a rival. Lead with the Shiksha affiliate angle.

₹1L test — sequence it, don't split 50/50 blind

- **₹60k → Meta now** (Conversions on `analysis_completed`; broad India 20–40, IT freshers/professionals, retargeting; Reels-first).
- **₹40k → held for the InfoEdge pilot**, preferring a **Shiksha** course-intent placement over Naukri.com display, UTM-tracked.
- **Hard gate:** if Naukri can't return click/conversion data into our UTM/PostHog, cap managed spend at ~₹25k — never commit the full ₹1L to a black box.
- **Single metric across both: cost per completed CV-analysis** (not impressions, not revenue). 30-day read → double down on the winner and automate it.

Add these to your call questions

- **Minimum commitment / lock-in:** "Smallest spend? Can we stop after 2 weeks? Any multi-month commitment?"
- **Exclusivity / throttling:** "Will promoting an upskilling tool conflict with FastForward — will you cap or throttle our reach?"
- **Sharpen cost:** ask for a written estimate of **cost-per-qualified-click to our site** (CPM is vanity for us).
- **Make attribution a go/no-go:** "Can you pass UTM/click-IDs or fire a near-real-time postback to our analytics?" No attribution = capped spend.

Do NOT agree to on the call: no minimum/multi-month lock-in (one cancellable pilot); no spend without written attribution/reporting (no black-box managed campaigns); no exclusivity that blocks running Meta/Google in parallel; no pure CPM/impression branding bundle (insist click- or lead-trackable); no sharing of our users' CV/PII, and no NVite email/SMS blast to their base without clear opt-in.

The fully-automated campaign lifecycle (create→optimise→pause via the Paperclip org) is designed and ready to build for Meta/Google once ad accounts + the Pixel are live.